the limited funds on offer made claims of collective action on climate change sound hollow. There is little doubt the entrenched politics of deadlock at climate negotiations breed cynicism about seriously addressing the problem. And yet, this would be an incomplete understanding of the problem and of possible ways forward.

The source of hope in climate politics and policy lies in looking beyond international negotiations. Fuelled by steep falls in the cost of renewable energy and a growing perception that these are the technologies of the future, Bloomberg estimates that investments in energy transition increased 17 per cent last year, and 27 per cent each in the two previous years. China has led the charge, but many other countries are following suit. Around the world, countries and businesses are now betting that the future of world energy is increasingly clean, and that they will gain global competitive advantage by being first movers. That clean energy can also help with issues such as air pollution and liveable cities is another motivation. This is heartening, because while addressing climate change goes beyond transitioning to clean energy alone, it is an essential part of the process.

Why has this growing convergence around clean energy not broken the negotiation deadlock, spurring a virtuous spiral of more ambitious global pledges and action? Countries are moving to low-carbon futures, just not fast enough to avoid global warming by at least 1.5 degrees Celsius and quite possibly 2°C. And the faster this change must happen, the more disruptive it is likely to be. As existing industries are disrupted, jobs will be lost in sectors like petrol car manufacturing and coal mining and will need to be replaced by new jobs. Scarce and costly capital will need to be reallocated away from other pressing development needs. People will need to be persuaded to change consumer habits around how they travel, cool their homes, and what they eat. All of these can be politically costly to governments. The potential for socially disruptive change is why countries are cautious about aggressive commitments and instead seek flexibility on the speed and extent of an energy transition.

What does this mean for India? We have considerable unmet energy needs and, because of low current and past emission levels per person, limited responsibility for climate change. Disruption, particularly in energy, could be costly. But we are also highly vulnerable to climate change and increasingly see possible gains to the Indian economy from being first movers in clean energy.

On the international front, India's likely choice is prudence—keeping the pressure on developed countries for emissions reductions and finance, preparing for an energy transition at home while limiting international pledges. However, claims to climate leadership will, sooner or later, come with pressures for more risk-taking, and bolder international pledges.

The more interesting possibilities, and the biggest scope for creative action, lie on the domestic side. The first order of business for India is to become more climate-resilient, because some level of warming is now inevitable. India, like all countries, must make our cities and coasts more climate-resilient and plan for adaptation in sectors such as agriculture and water; city-by-city heat action plans will be a good start. This is not a trivial task. It requires local-level planning, scientific infrastructure and more effective governments at all levels.

INDIA MUST BECOME **CLIMATE-RESILIENT AND ALSO BUILD A LOW-CARBON ECONOMY** THAT CAN CREATE JOBS AROUND THIS. THE GOVERNMENT MUST COORDINATE ACROSS MINISTRIES, STATES, AND LOCAL EFFORTS

Second, India will be well served by doubling down on our efforts to build a low-carbon economy that creates jobs. The current somewhat scattershot approach should ideally give way to a more strategic approach. We need to identify competitive opportunities with job-creating possibilities, and areas where clean energy transition serves development goals such as reducing air pollution. Key upgrades required include enhanced investment in technological R&D, policymaking around complementary packages rather than individual policies to induce long-term changes, a regional planning approach, particularly for coal regions that may be the hardest hit, and strategic efforts to harness green capital from India and overseas.

Third, India, like most countries, does not have a government designed for the complexities of climate change. The task requires strategic ability to induce economic transformation and coordinate between ministries; the task extends well beyond the environment ministry to agriculture, water, power, coal and urban development ministries, and many

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